Bariatric Clinic Activity & Engagement Trends (2021–2025)

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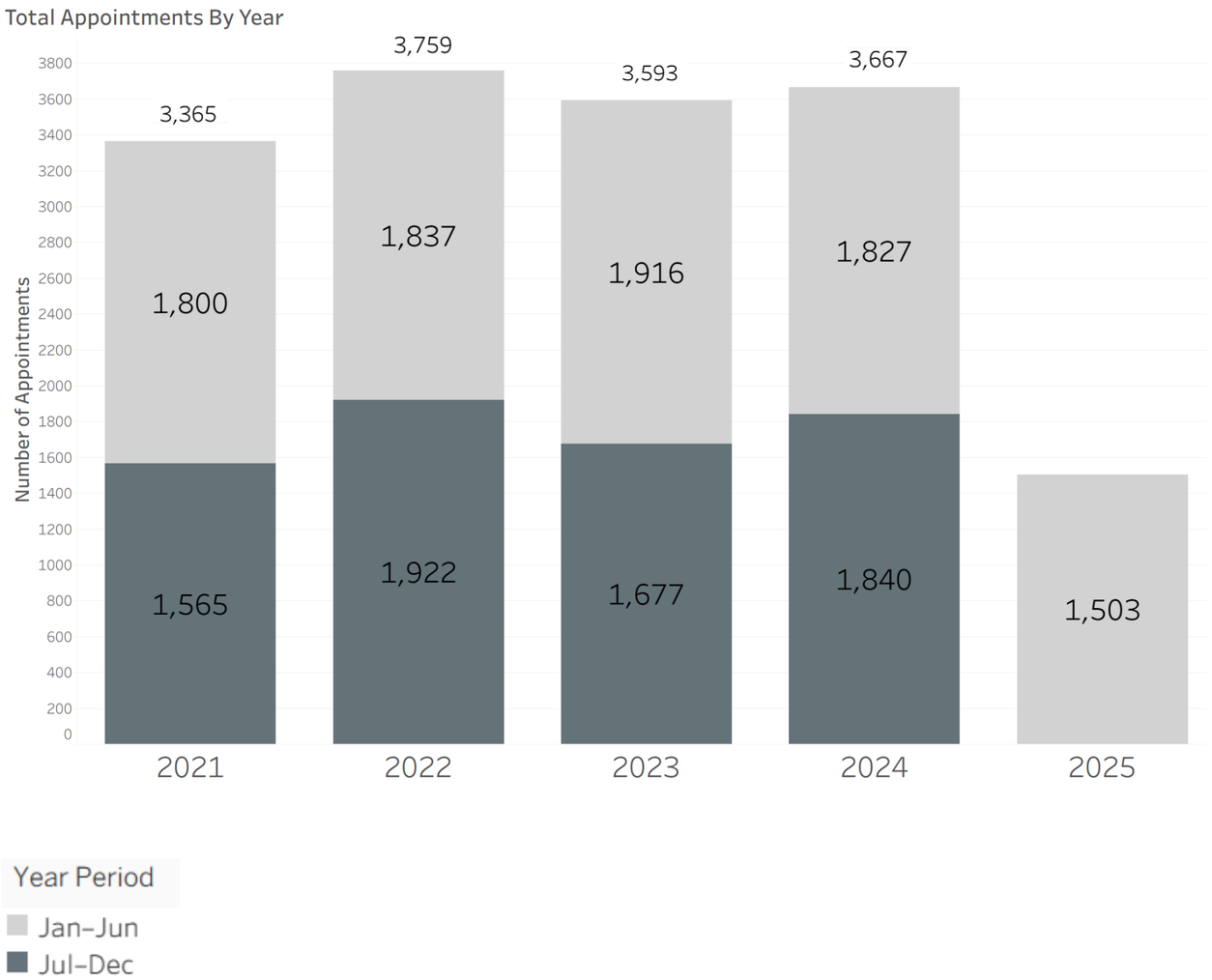
What prompted this review

In response to reports of declining bariatric surgery volume nationwide, the CFO requested a review of local bariatric clinic trends.

Data review: all bariatric clinic activity from 2021 – 2025

- Note: 2025 data shown through June only (not annualized)

Clinic activity overview (2025 data through June)



Insight

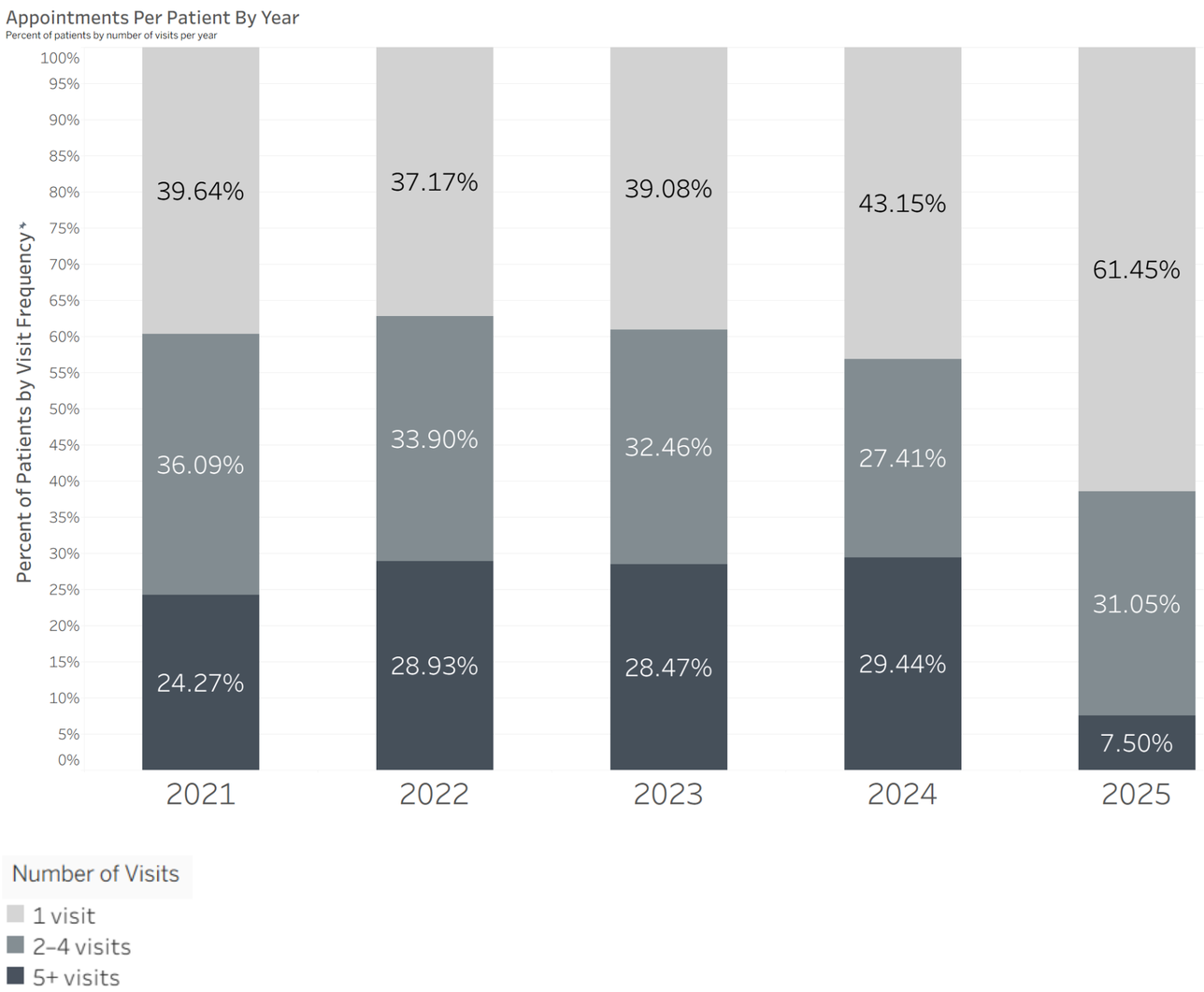
Appointment volume remained relatively stable from 2021–2024.

2025 activity appears lower but reflects partial year data.

Recommendation

Next, we normalize to assess whether this reflects timing or engagement.

Patient engagement is changing



Insight

2025 shows a sharp increase in single visit patients.

Fewer patients progressing to repeat visits.

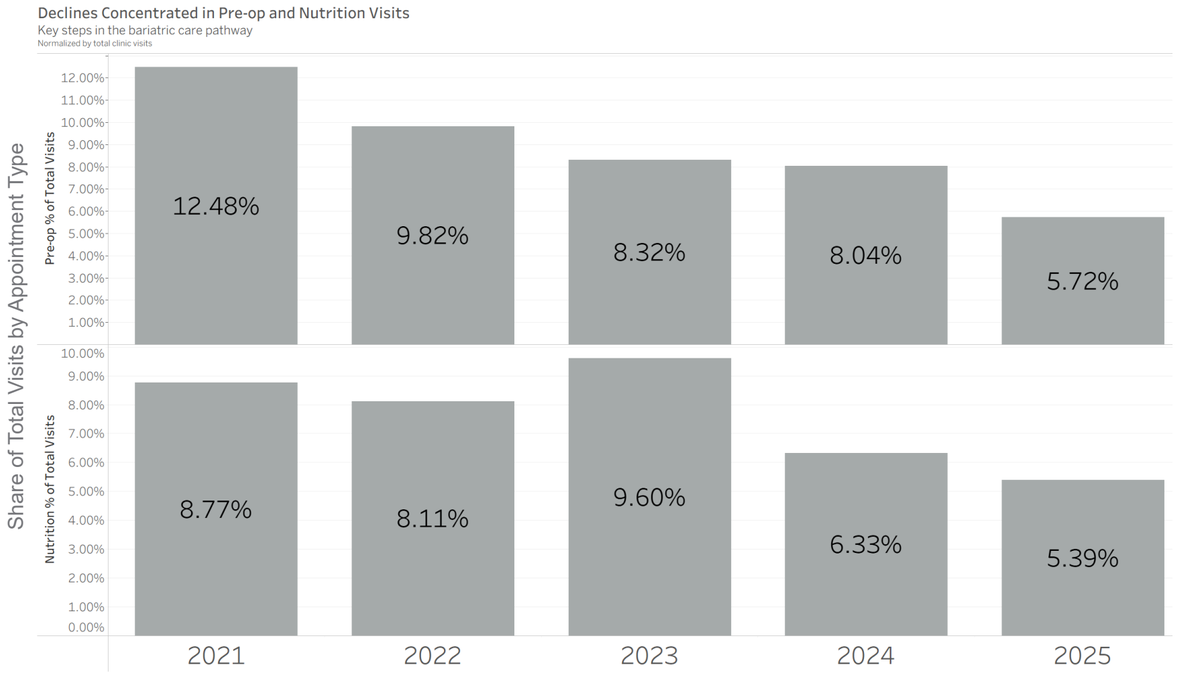
Interpretation

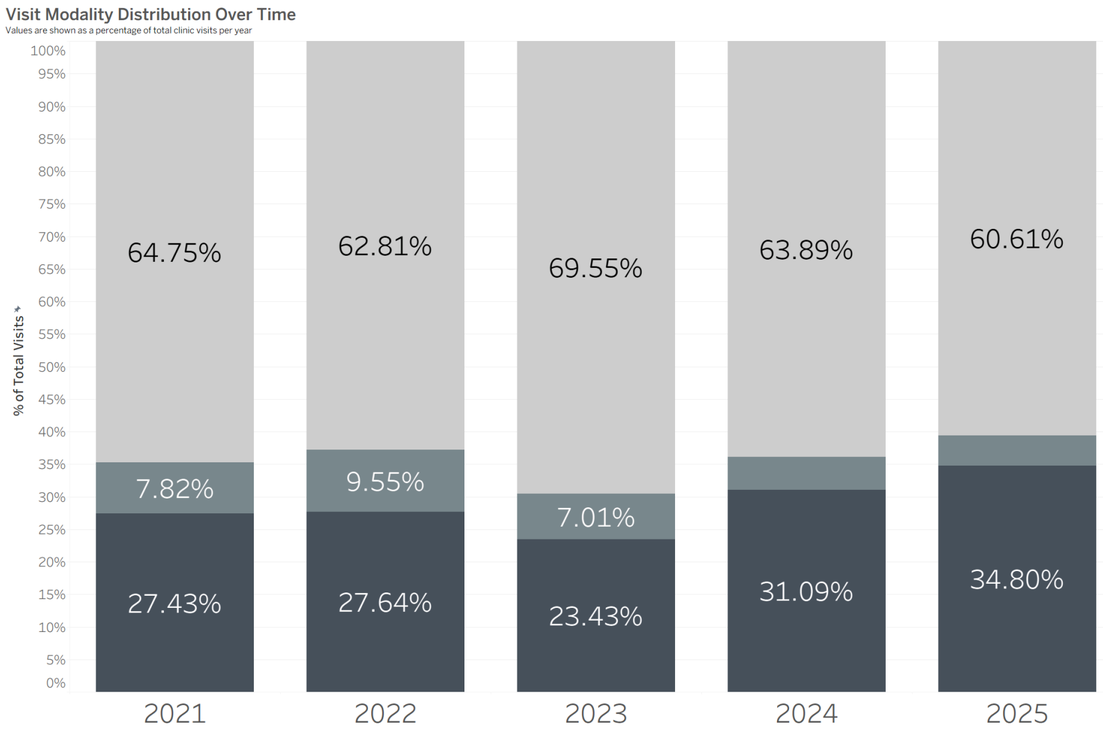
Fewer patients are progressing beyond the initial visit.

Drop off appears earlier in the care journey.

This pattern aligns with reduced pre-op and nutrition visits seen later.

What may be contributing to reduced follow through





Insight

Declines concentrated in pre-op and nutrition visits, which are critical steps before surgery and long term follow up.

Modality mix shifted toward video visits.

Interpretation

These are contributing factors, not conclusions.

National context: Organizations such as ASMBS have noted stabilization and some softening in bariatric surgery growth, alongside broader weight management approaches.

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Recommended next steps

Validate definitions and scope with EIS

- Confirm appointment type mapping and 2025 completeness

Map the bariatric care pathway

- Initial consultant ➡ Pre-operative evaluation ➡ Surgical procedure ➡ Post-operative follow up ➡ Ongoing nutrition management

Targeted operational actions

- Focus outreach on pre op and nutrition drop off
- Review scheduling and access constraints